

Addition to Justified True Belief (JTB)

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Justified True Belief (JTB)——the definition of knowledge consisting of truth, belief, and adequate evidence——is challenged by Edmund L.G. through two cases. From my perspective, those two cases don't constitute a threat to JTB theory, because in both cases adequate evidence is absent.

In case I, Smith's evidence, being assured by the president of the company that Jones would in the end be selected, shouldn't be considered as adequate evidence, as obviously, in the end the president didn't select Jones. How can evidence be considered adequate if it is possible to be disobeyed? Likewise, in case II, **if the Ford in which Smith was offered a ride by Jones, who was at that time driving the very vehicle which was actually rented, how could such an offer be adequate evidence of Jones owing the Ford?** Therefore, the evidence in both cases failed to be adequate.

It seems that the problem being easily solved perfectly. However, this comes at a cost. To such a strict extent of evidence being adequate, it is almost impossible for us to acquire knowledge, as such evidence is also scarcely able to have. In my view, the kind of knowledge under the JTB framework itself is, and surely is, hard to exist. That's not a delightful thing, so can we fix the definition? And how?

In my opinion, to fix so, we shall change the 'evidence' condition a little bit. We shall turn it into——S is directly justified in believing that P or S directly derives P through purely logical derivation from a directly justified knowledge. As for the two cases, it is directly justified that Smith considered himself being justified by the president of the company that Jones would in the end be selected. And the statement of Jones would in the end be selected is actually a belief inferred that knowledge. This process goes like this, it is one's belief that a thing considered to oneself is true to him. Therefore, Smith was justified by the president of the company that Jones would in the end be selected. Furthermore, it is also one's belief that a thing on a company justified by the president of the company is true. Therefore, Jones would in the end be selected. Finally, it is also one's belief that a man being selected will get the job. Therefore, we reached the point that Jones would get the job. As mentioned, the statement we used to reach our final point is our belief, but not our knowledge, as it is almost impossible to be justified through direct evidence. It is easy to understand as there is hardly any universal evidence about such a thing. Therefore, the final statement of Jones would get the job is only a belief, and it is possible for a belief to become wrong.

As for belief, the opinion that I agree with is that belief should be such things that

haven't been proved to be wrong yet. And with that definition, we are able to remove the authorization for belief at any time when contradictory evidence is being acquired. And a belief is more likely to qualify as knowledge under the JTB framework if it is supported by additional evidence gathered after the belief has been formed. That is to say, with more and more supporting evidence, the belief inferred from the directly justified knowledge is more likely to be true, and more likely to become a knowledge, but never can it become a knowledge.

Reaching this point, I come up with an interesting question. Suppose there is a phenomenon which we acquired two evidences related to one after another. And there are two knowledge about the phenomenon. One is raised before the second evidence, and is later being supported by the second evidence. The other is raised after the two evidences are being acquired, and also tallies with them. The question is 'Is the first knowledge more likely to qualify the definition of knowledge under the JTB framework than the second one, as the second evidence acts as a support in it? Or, is the two knowledge qualify the JTB concept to the same extent, no matter how the evidences are used?' An example for this could be two evidences in Mendel's Pea Plant Experiments, and his theory on heredity.